

Financial Readiness Checklist

For Founders Ready to Scale

Blueprints & Bookkeeping, LLC | blueprintsandbookkeeping.com

Use this checklist to evaluate your financial infrastructure before approaching lenders, investors, or scaling operations. Each item represents a critical area that underwriters and financial partners will scrutinize.

1. Revenue & Expense Tracking

- ☐ All business income is recorded in a dedicated business account (no personal mixing)
- ☐ Revenue is categorized by stream/product line for clear reporting
- ☐ All expenses are categorized consistently using a standard chart of accounts
- ☐ Recurring vs. one-time expenses are clearly distinguished
- ☐ Monthly reconciliation is performed within 15 days of month-end

2. Key Financial Ratios Lenders Evaluate

- ☐ Debt-to-Equity Ratio is calculated and within healthy range (typically < 2:1)
- ☐ Current Ratio (current assets / current liabilities) is above 1.2
- ☐ Gross Profit Margin is documented and trending positively
- ☐ Operating Cash Flow is positive for the trailing 12 months
- ☐ Debt Service Coverage Ratio (DSCR) meets minimum lender threshold (typically > 1.25)

3. Common Red Flags to Fix Now

- ☐ No unclassified or "Ask My Accountant" transactions in your books
- ☐ No personal expenses running through business accounts
- ☐ Payroll tax filings are current with no outstanding liabilities
- ☐ Sales tax collection and remittance is up to date
- ☐ No duplicate entries, ghost vendors, or stale receivables over 90 days

4. Lender-Readiness Timeline

- ☐ 3 years of clean, reconciled financial statements are available (P&L + Balance Sheet)
- ☐ Tax returns for the last 2-3 years are filed and accessible
- ☐ A 12-month cash flow projection has been prepared and stress-tested
- ☐ A 3-to-5-year business plan with financial forecasts is current
- ☐ An executive summary is ready for initial lender conversations

5. Before You Hire a Bookkeeper

- ☐ What is their experience with your industry and entity structure?
- ☐ Do they use your accounting software (e.g., QuickBooks Online)?
- ☐ Are they onshore and available year-round (no tax-season blackouts)?
- ☐ Can they provide lender-ready reports — not just data entry?
- ☐ Do they cap their client roster for quality assurance?

Ready to Get Lender-Ready?

Blueprints & Bookkeeping specializes in advanced bookkeeping and lender-ready business plans for founders who have outgrown generalist solutions. We cap our roster at 20 active clients to ensure executive-level dedication.

Schedule your free discovery call:

blueprintsandbookkeeping.com/contact

tea@blueprintsandbookkeeping.com | (541) 319-8654